

The Sermon on the Mount: The Upside-Down Kingdom

ገጽ 50 ከ 60 ገጾች ውስጥ

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 50 of 60

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Scene 1

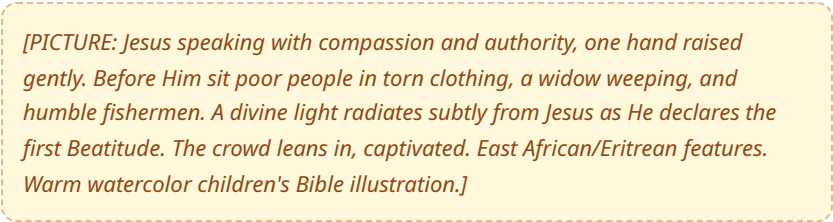
[PICTURE: Jesus climbing a green hillside overlooking the Sea of Galilee, followed by hundreds of people — men, women, children, elderly. He sits down on a large flat rock as the crowd settles on the grassy slope below. Morning sunlight bathes the scene in golden warmth. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The crowds had been growing for weeks. Word spread across Galilee that a rabbi from Nazareth was healing every disease, casting out demons, and speaking with an authority no one had ever heard. People traveled from Syria, the Decapolis, Jerusalem, and beyond the Jordan to find Him. Now, seeing the multitudes, Jesus climbed a hillside, sat down — the posture of a rabbi about to deliver something significant — and opened His mouth to teach. What followed would become the most revolutionary speech in human history.

[illegible]

(Hizbi nisamunitat kibezihi tsenehe. Kab Nazret zimetsee rebi nikulu himam kem zifiwis aganninti kem zisegug zikhone seb simi'iwo zeyflit siltan kem zizareb zena ab milu'e Gelila tezergihe. Sebat kab Sorya, Deqapolis, Iyerusalem, ma'ido Yordanos kirekhibwo metsu. Hiji neti buzuh hizbi ri'iyu Yesus nab keren deyebe, teqemete — agedasi neger kimhir ziqerebe rebi aqemamtsa — afu khefitu kimhir jemere. Zisi'ib zinebere ab tarikh seb aziyu sewrawi zikhone niqir kikhewn'yu zinebero.)

Scene 2



"Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." With these opening words, Jesus turned everything the world believed about success completely upside down. In that culture — and in ours — blessing meant wealth, health, power, and status. But Jesus declared that God's kingdom belongs to those who recognize their spiritual emptiness, who know they have nothing to offer God and desperately need Him. This isn't about material poverty — it's about the death of pride, the recognition that we are spiritually bankrupt without God.

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(Bimenfes dikhhatat bitsuan iyom mikiniyatu mengiste semayat natatom'ya. Bezen nay mekhfeti qalat Yesus alem biza'iba awet zi'amenetoo kulu neger fitsum gelbeto. Ab'ti bahli — ab natna'wun — bereket malet habti, ti'ina, siltan'n dereja'n'yu zinebere. Gin Yesus mengisti Amlak naytom menfesawi badonetom zi'afiltu ni'Amlak zihbiwo wala hanti kem zeyebloim zifeltu bitesfa miqurats zedliyom mkhwana aweje.

*Izi biza'iba nay niwat dikhinet ayikonen — biza'iba mot ti'ibit'yu bizey Amlak
menfesawi tifuat mkhwanna mi'iman'yu.)*

Scene 3

[PICTURE: Jesus continuing to teach the Beatitudes. In the crowd, a mourning woman wipes tears, a gentle man helps a fallen child, and a person with a pure expression gazes upward. Each Beatitude is shown through the people listening. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted." Jesus declared that grief — over sin, over injustice, over brokenness — is not weakness but a doorway to God's comfort. "Blessed are the meek, for they will inherit the earth." Not the aggressive, not the powerful who seize what they want, but the meek — those who have strength under control, who refuse to use their power to dominate others. The world says the aggressive inherit the earth. Jesus says the exact opposite. "Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they will be filled." God satisfies those who crave justice and holiness the way a starving person craves bread.

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(Zihaznu bitsuan'yom mikiniyatu kitsenani'u'yom. Yesus hazen — bisenki hati'at bizeyifitihawnet bisibrat — dikham zeyikone nab mitsinina'e Amlak zimirih ma'itsho mkhwanu aweje. Lewahat bitsuan'yom mikiniyatu nimidri kiwerswa'yom. Netom chekanat siltan hizom zideleyw ziwisdu zeyikone lewahat — haylom biqutstsir zihizu nikhal'ot kigez'u siltanom kitiqemu zi'abiyu'yom. Alem chekanat nimidri yiwerswa tibil. Yesus fitsum antsaru yibil. Nitsidqi zitemiyu'n zitsemi'u'n bitsuan'yom mikiniyatu

*kitsegibu'yom. Amlak netom kem zitemeye seb ni'injera zibihgo nifitih'n qidisna'n
zibihgu yetsegirbom.)*

[PICTURE: Jesus speaking about peacemakers and the persecuted. In the crowd, one person extends a hand to reconcile two arguing men. Another person stands apart, being mocked by a group, yet maintaining a peaceful expression. A dove flies overhead symbolizing peace. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Blessed are the merciful, for they will be shown mercy. Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God. Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God." Jesus valued mercy over vengeance, purity of motive over outward performance, and active peacemaking over passive neutrality. Then came the most shocking declaration: "Blessed are those who are persecuted for righteousness' sake." Being hated for following Jesus is not a curse — it's a confirmation that you belong to His kingdom. The world's rejection is heaven's approval.

[illegible]

(Mihret zigebru bitsuan'yom mikiniyatu mihret kirekhibu'yom. Bilibi nitsuhhat bitsuan'yom mikiniyatu ni'Amlak kiri'iywo'yom. Selam zigebru bitsuan'yom mikiniyatu deqi Amlak kibehalu'yom. Yesus kab hine mihret kab gidamawi fitsame nitsihina ilama kab tekwal gelelitenyenet nituf misrah selam akhibere. Dihri'u iti aziyu zidenits awaj metse, "Sile tsidqi zisdedu bitsuan'yom." NiYesus bimsi'ab mitsla'e rigiman ayikonen — nay mengist'u mkhwanka mirigats'yu. Alem minitsag nay semay miqibal'yu.)

Scene 6

[PICTURE: Jesus holding an ancient Torah scroll with reverence, unrolling it partially. Light shines from the scroll. Around Him, Pharisees in the crowd look suspicious, while common people listen with hope. The hillside is lush and green. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets," Jesus said with absolute authority. "I have not come to abolish them but to fulfill them." This was critical. Jesus wasn't erasing the Old Testament or starting from scratch. He was completing what it always pointed toward. Every prophecy, every sacrificial lamb, every commandment — all of it found its ultimate meaning in Him. He raised the standard, not lowered it. "Until heaven and earth disappear, not the smallest letter will disappear from the Law until everything is accomplished."

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(Higi wey nebiyat kifris kem zimetsaekhu ayitihisebu Yesus bifitsum siltan bele.
Kifrisom zeyikone kifitsmom'ye zimetsaekhu. Izi wesani nebere. Yesus Biluy Kidan
yidimssis wey kab bado yijimir ayineberen. Kab qedem zemelketo kifitsim'yu zinebere.
Kulu tinbit kulu nay meswa'ihiti genshel kulu ti'izaz — kulu nay mewedda'ita
trigumuab'u'yu zirekhiboo. Nidereja a'ibeyoye'mber ayitenkiyon. Semay'n midir'n
kisab zihilif kulu kisab zifitsem kab higi iti zini'ase fidel ayihalifn'yu.)

Scene 7

[PICTURE: Jesus teaching with intensity, pointing to His heart. Behind Him, a visual split — on one side, a man outwardly calm but with a dark storm cloud forming inside his chest representing hidden anger; on the other side, two brothers embracing in reconciliation near a temple altar. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"You have heard that it was said, 'You shall not murder.' But I tell you that anyone who is angry with a brother or sister will be subject to judgment." The crowd must have gasped. Jesus was saying that the commandment against murder isn't just about physical violence — it reaches into the heart. Anger, contempt, hateful words — these are murder of the soul. Calling someone worthless, nursing a grudge, refusing to reconcile — these poison us from within. Jesus demanded that before you even offer worship to God, if someone has something against you, go and make it right first. Relationships matter more than rituals.

[illegible]

(Ayitiqtel tebahhilu kem zitebahle simi'ikhum ikhum. Ane gin nihaw ziquta'e kulu firdi kiqrebellu'yu iblekhum. Hizbi zidengetse kikhewn alewo. Yesus iti nay qitlet ti'izaz biza'iba akalawi amets tiray zeyikone nab libi kem zibetsih yizareb nebere. Qut'a ni'iqet tserfi — izi'om nay nefsi qitlet'yom. Nihade seb waga-albo mibal qirhinti mihaz mi'irraq mi'abay — izi'om kab wishti yimerzuna. Yesus ni'Amlak misigana qidmi miqirabka hade seb neger mis zelewo kid qidam aqemto hatete. Rikibat kab sir'atat zi'abi'yu.)

Scene 8

[PICTURE: Jesus speaking seriously about purity of heart. A young man in the crowd looks down in conviction. Around the scene, visual metaphors — a guarded eye, a protected heart with a shield around it, and a person turning their face away from temptation. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"You have heard that it was said, 'You shall not commit adultery.' But I tell you that anyone who looks at someone lustfully has already committed adultery in their heart." Again, Jesus drove past behavior to the heart. Sin doesn't begin with the action — it begins with the thought, the lingering look, the unchecked desire. Jesus was teaching that God isn't simply a judge of actions; He is a searcher of hearts. You can appear righteous to everyone around you while harboring corruption within. Jesus calls us to wage war against sin at its root, not just its fruit.

[illegible]

(Ayitizemu tebahhilu kem zitebahle simi'ikhum ikhum. Ane gin nisebeyti bifiwewet zitimit kulu diro ab libu zemiru'yu iblekhum. Kemu'wun Yesus nibahriyat halifu nab libi atewe. Hati'at bitegbar zeyikone bihasab bizetsenihe temete bizeyiteqotsatsere dilet'ya tijimir. Yesus Amlak nay tegbarat feradi tiray zeyikone nay libi mermari mkhwanu yimhir nebere. Nikhulom ab kebabikha tsadiq kitimesil tikhil gin ab wishitikha bilishiwna hizkha. Yesus ab fire tiray zeyikone ab sur hati'at wigeo kingebir yitsu'i.)

Scene 9

[PICTURE: A dramatic scene showing Jesus' radical teaching on loving enemies. On one side, a person is slapped on the cheek and turns the other cheek with dignity. On the other side, a person gives their cloak to someone who took their tunic. Jesus watches approvingly. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"You have heard that it was said, 'Eye for eye, tooth for tooth.' But I tell you, do not resist an evil person. If anyone slaps you on the right cheek, turn to them the other cheek also." This is not passivity or weakness — it is a radical refusal to be defined by your enemy's behavior. Turning the other cheek is an act of strength: it says, "You cannot make me become like you. You cannot turn me into a person of hate." Jesus was calling His followers to break the cycle of violence and vengeance that enslaves humanity. Retaliation feels powerful, but it actually makes you a slave to the person who wronged you.

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(Ayni bi'ayni sini bisini tebahhilu kem zitebahle simi'ikhum ikhum. Ane gin nikhu'e seb ayitiqawemu iblekhum. Ab yemanayi minga'ikha zitsefa'ka neta khalaitii'wun mileselu. Izi gideleinyet wey dikhham ayikonon — bibahri tselaikha kitglets sewrawi mi'ibay'yu. Kal'e minga'e mimlas nay hayli tegbar'yu, "Kemakha kitgebreni aytikhiln. Nay tsilii seb kitgebreni aytikhiln" yibil. Yesus nisi'ibat'u niseb zi'asir nay amets'n hine'n zuriya kisebru yitsu'i nebere. Hine hayal yimesil gin bihaqi neti zibedelesa seb barya yigebreka.)

Scene 10

[PICTURE: Jesus speaking about loving enemies. Behind Him, a powerful image — a person kneeling in prayer for someone who stands over them with a raised fist. Light flows from the praying person toward the enemy. The sun rises in the background, shining on both good and evil people equally. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"You have heard that it was said, 'Love your neighbor and hate your enemy.' But I tell you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you, that you may be children of your Father in heaven. He causes His sun to rise on the evil and the good, and sends rain on the righteous and the unrighteous." This is perhaps the most impossible command Jesus ever gave. Love those who hate you? Pray for those who destroy you? Yet Jesus pointed to God's own example: God gives sunshine and rain to everyone — not because they deserve it, but because generosity is His nature. If we only love those who love us back, we are no different from anyone else.

[illegible]

(Nibitsaykha fito nitselaikha tsila'e tebahilu kem zitebahle simi'ikhum ikhum. Ane gin nitsel'itkhum fito netom ziseddukhum tseliyulom iblekhum, nay ab semay zelo Abokhum deqi mi'inti kitkhonu. Nisu ab li'ili khu'at'n hiyawot'n tseyay'u yebrih ab li'ili tsadiqan'n hat'ian'n zinam yisedid. Izi minalbat Yesus zihabo aziyu zeyike'al ti'izaz'yu. Nizitselu'kha mifiqar? Nizidimssu'kha mitslay? Gin Yesus nab abnet Amlak ba'ilu amelkete, Amlak nikulu tseyay'n zinam'n yihib — sile zigiba'om zeyikone legas

*bahri'u sile zikhone. Netom zifetiwwuna tiray inte fetina kab zikhone seb zifle
ayikonan.)*

Scene 11

[PICTURE: A split scene — on the left, a Pharisee praying loudly on a street corner with a trumpet announcing his giving, people watching and applauding him. On the right, a humble person praying quietly alone in a small room, with God's light shining down on them. Jesus gestures toward the humble one approvingly. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

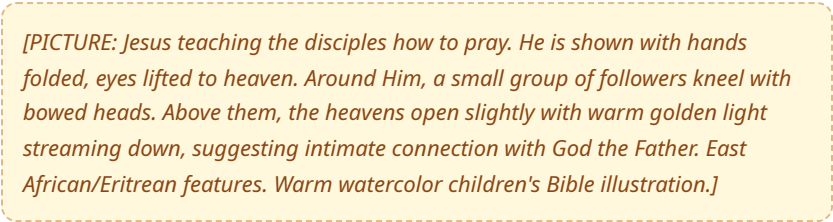
"Be careful not to practice your righteousness in front of others to be seen by them. If you do, you will have no reward from your Father in heaven." Jesus exposed the most dangerous form of sin — religious hypocrisy. When you give to the poor, don't announce it with trumpets like the hypocrites do in the synagogues and streets. When you pray, don't stand on corners to be seen. When you fast, don't look miserable to impress others. The hypocrite's reward is human applause — and that's all they'll ever receive. But those who serve God in secret? "Your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you."

[illegible]

(Tsidigqhum sebat kiri'yqhum ab qidmi'om keytitgebru tetinqeq. Inte gebirkhum kab ab semay zelo Abokhum asbi yebilukhumn. Yesus neti aziyu hadegnya aynet hati'at — haymanotawi gibizna qele'o. Nidikhhata kithibu kelekhum kem gibzat ab bete tselot'n godenataT'n zigebrwo bimelekhet ayitinfihi. Kititsliyu kelekhum sebat kiri'yqhum ab kurnaat dew ayitbelu. Kitisommu kelekhum nikhal'ot ketegimu

tsigumat ayitimiselu. Asbi gibzat nay seb taqit'yu — ziqeblwo zebele iti tiray'yu. Gin netom bistur ni'Amlak zigelgilu? "Abokha bistur zigber ziri'i yihitefeka'yu.")

Scene 12



"This, then, is how you should pray: 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.'" Jesus gave His followers a model for prayer that begins not with our needs, but with God's glory. "Our Father" — intimate, personal relationship. "Hallowed be your name" — reverence and awe before His holiness. "Your kingdom come" — surrendering our agenda to His. "Your will be done on earth as in heaven" — aligning our desires with God's purposes. Prayer is not a shopping list; it is realignment of our hearts with heaven's priorities.

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(Kemzi ilkhum tseleyu, "Ab semay zelekha Abona simka yiqedes mengistikha timtsa'e fiqadka ab midri kem ab semay yikhun." Yesus nisi'ibat'u bidiletana zeyikone bikibri Amlak zijimir nay tselot abnet habom. "Abona" — qirbet wilqawi rikib. "Simka yiqedes" — qidmi qidisna'u akhibrot'n dinqi'n. "Mengistikha timtsa'e" — ni'ajendana nab'u mihdag. "Fiqadka ab midri kem ab semay yikhun" — diletana mis ilama Amlak

*misimima'e. Tselot nay idgi zirzir ayikonen; libna mis qedamnetat semay dagim
misirra'e'yu.)*

Scene 13

[PICTURE: Jesus continuing to teach the Lord's Prayer. Visual elements show bread being shared (daily bread), two people forgiving each other with clasped hands (forgive us our debts), and a shield protecting someone from a dark shadowy figure (deliver us from evil). East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Give us today our daily bread." Not weekly, not yearly — daily. God wants us to depend on Him moment by moment. "And forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors." This is terrifying if you think about it — we are asking God to forgive us in the same measure we forgive others. If we hold grudges, we are asking God to hold grudges against us. "And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one." We acknowledge our weakness and ask for God's protection. The Lord's Prayer is a complete reorientation of life — from self-centered to God-centered, from anxious to trusting, from bitter to forgiving.

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(Nay ilet injerana lomi habena. Samuntawi zeyikone ametatawi zeyikone — iletawi. Amlak himot bihimot kinimirkoselu yideli. Nihina nizibehdluna kem zihadeginayom abesana hidggelna. Biza'iba'zi mis tihhasib zefrih'yu — nikhal'ot binihading'om meten Amlak kihidgelna nihitit ina. Qirhinti hizna Amlak'wun abana qirhinti kihiz nihitit alena. Nab fetena ayite'itiwena kab khu'e adhhinena. Dikhhamna nefilit nay

*Amlak halewa nihitit. Nay Goyta tselot nay hiwet milu'e miqiyar'yu — kab ri'ise-
ma'ikelawi nab Amlak-ma'ikelawi kab sigi'at nab mi'iman kab merir nab yiqire.)*

Scene 14

[PICTURE: Jesus pointing to a treasure chest buried in the ground versus treasures stored in heaven (shown as golden light above the clouds). A moth eats through fine clothing, and rust corrodes coins on one side. On the other side, eternal treasures glow imperishably in heaven's light. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moths and vermin destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven." Jesus wasn't condemning wealth itself, but the worship of wealth — making money your security, your identity, your god. "For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also." Whatever you invest in most reveals what you truly love. "No one can serve two masters. You cannot serve both God and money." This is not a suggestion — it is an impossibility. You will inevitably love one and despise the other. Every human must choose.

[illegible]

(Bili'i nizibili'o mezgebi zisibro seraqi zisirqo ab midri niri'iskhum habti ayiti'iqebu. Ab semay habti iqebu. Yesus nihabti ba'ilu zeyikone ni'amilkho habti — genzeb wihisineetka mennetka Amlakhka migbar — kununu. Habtikha ab zelewó libkha'wun ab'u'yu zikhewn. Zibezihe itiwfrelu bihaqi zitifetu yigelits. Nikilte goytoy kegeligil zikhil hade'kwa yelen. Ni'Amlakh'n niqenzenb'n kiteqeligailu aytikhilun. Izi ri'iyto zeyikone

zeyike'al mkhwanu'yu. Nay gidin nihade kitfetu neti kal'e kitin'iqu ikhum. Kulu seb kimrits alewo.)

Scene 15

[PICTURE: Jesus gesturing toward colorful birds flying freely in the sky and beautiful wildflowers (lilies) growing on the hillside. The crowd looks up at the birds and down at the flowers. A worried person in the crowd relaxes as they hear Jesus' words about God's provision. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or drink; or about your body, what you will wear." Jesus pointed to the birds soaring overhead. "Look at the birds of the air; they do not sow or reap or store away in barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not much more valuable than they?" Then He pointed to the wildflowers carpeting the hillside. "See how the lilies of the field grow. Not even Solomon in all his splendor was dressed like one of these." If God clothes temporary grass with such beauty, how much more will He provide for His children? Worry is essentially a statement of unbelief — it says God cannot be trusted with tomorrow.

[illegible]

(Slezi bihiwetkhum intay kem tibeliu wey tistiya bi'akalkhum intay kem tikhidenu ayitichenequ iblekhum. Yesus nab ab la'ili ziberra a'iwaf amelkete. Nab a'iwaf semay temtu; ayizri'a ayiatsda ab qofo ayi'ikiban gin semayawi Abokhum yimgiben. Niskhatkhum kabataten aziyu buzuh waqa zelekhum ayikonkhumn'do? Dihri'u abti

kurba zi'abebe nay berekha inbaba amelkete. Nay meror inbaba bikemey kem zi'abi ri'eyu. Selomon'wun bikulu khibru kem hade kabataten ayitekhidinen. Amlak nigizeyawi sa'iri bikemzi tsibaqe zikhdin nidequ'khe kindey ziyada kiqrib'yu? Chinqet ab meseretu nay zeymi'iman awaj'ya — Amlak bimetsai ki'amin ayike'aln tibil.)

*nihat'i'at ayinigetimu malet ayikonen — gin bitihitina nay ba'ilna sibrat bimfilag
nihade seb bihaqenya fiqri nigebro.)*

Scene 18

[PICTURE: Jesus encouraging people to pray boldly. A child knocks on a large wooden door that is beginning to open, golden light spilling out from behind it. Another person searches intently with a lamp, finding a treasure. A third person asks with outstretched hands and receives bread from above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives; the one who seeks finds; and to the one who knocks, the door will be opened." Jesus painted God not as a reluctant judge who must be persuaded, but as a generous Father eager to give. "Which of you, if your son asks for bread, will give him a stone? If you then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!" God's generosity exceeds our most optimistic expectations. We can approach Him boldly, not because we deserve it, but because He delights in giving.

[illegible]

(Leminu kiwihabekhum'yu; dileyu kitrekhibu ikhum; kuhkuhu kikhifetelekhum'yu. Zilemin kulu yiqebel zideli yirekib nizikhuhkhu yikhifetelu. Yesus ni'Amlak ki'imena zelew senfenya feradi zeyikone kihib zibihig legas Abo geyru sa'ilo. Wedu injera zihatoo alet zihibo ab ma'ikelkhum men alo? Niskhatkhum khu'at kinskkhum niwludkhum tsibug hiyab mihab mis feletkhum ab semay zelo Abokhum nizihatiwo

*tsibuq neger kindey ziyada yihibom! Legasnet Amlak kab aziyu tesfawi titsbitatna
yi'abi. Bidifret kinqerbo nikhil sile zigiba'na zeyikone mihab sile zehaguso.)*

Scene 19

[PICTURE: Jesus teaching the Golden Rule. Two people treat each other with kindness — one gives water to a thirsty traveler, the other shares food with a hungry child. A golden thread of light connects them, symbolizing reciprocity. The crowd nods in understanding. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"So in everything, do to others what you would have them do to you, for this sums up the Law and the Prophets." This single sentence — the Golden Rule — summarizes the entire ethical teaching of Scripture. It is radical because it shifts the question from "What can I get away with?" to "How would I want to be treated?" It demands empathy, imagination, and selflessness. Before you speak about someone, ask: "Would I want someone saying this about me?" Before you act, ask: "Would I want this done to me?" This one principle, genuinely lived out, would transform every relationship, every community, every nation.

[illegible]

(Slezi ab kulu neger sebat kigebirulkhum zitideleyu niskhatkhum'wun ni'a'atom kemu'u giberu hig'n nebiyat'n'zi'yu. Iza hanti hareg — werqawi higi — nikulu sine-migbarawi timhirti tsihuf titeqalil. Sewrawi'ya mikiniyatu neti hito kab "intay geyre kihalif yikhil?" nab "bikemey kihizuni mideleykhu?" tiqiyro. Rihrahi nay mihisab ki'ilet'n qini'ina'n tihitit. Biza'iba hade seb qidmi mizrabka hitet, "Hade seb biza'ibay kemzi kibil mideleykhu'do?" Qidmi miqbarka hitet, "Izi abay kigber mideleykhu'do?"

Izi hade metikel bihaqi zitrinebere nikulu rikib kulu mahbereseb kulu hager miqeyere neyru.)

Scene 20

[PICTURE: Two gates side by side on a hillside path. The narrow gate is small, humble, and has few people entering — but beyond it lies a beautiful sunlit garden with a clear path. The wide gate is grand and ornate with crowds rushing through — but beyond it, the path descends into darkness and destruction. Jesus points toward the narrow gate. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Enter through the narrow gate. For wide is the gate and broad is the road that leads to destruction, and many enter through it. But small is the gate and narrow the road that leads to life, and only a few find it." Jesus was blunt: following Him is not the popular path. The world's way is easy, comfortable, and crowded — but it leads to ruin. God's way is demanding, countercultural, and often lonely — but it leads to true life. You cannot follow the crowd and follow Jesus at the same time. The narrow gate requires you to leave behind the baggage of the world — pride, self-righteousness, comfortable compromises — and enter with nothing but trust in God.

[illegible]

(Bitsebib ma'itsho ite'u. Nab tifi'at zimerih ma'itsho gefih'yu megedi'wun rihbiti'ya bi'a'a zi'atiwu'wun buzuhat'yom. Gin nab hiwet zimerih ma'itsho tsebibi'yu megedi'wun tsebab'ya zirekhibwa'wun hidet'yom. Yesus bigiltsii tezarebe, ni'a'u misi'ab hibub megedi ayikonen. Nay alem megedi qelil michue'e buzuh hizbi

zelewo'yu — gin nab inwet'yu zimerih. Nay Amlak megedi hatati antsar-bahli hade hade gize bihitawi'yu — gin nab haqenya hiwet'yu zimerih. Nihizib'n niYesus'n bihade gize kitsi'ibom aytikhiln. Iti tsebib ma'itsho nay alem tsa'iqi — ti'ibit ri'ise-tsidqi michue'e dingisetsat — gedifka bimi'iman Amlak tiray kiti'atu yihitit.)

Scene 21

[PICTURE: Jesus warning about false prophets. On one side, a wolf wearing a sheep's fleece approaches a flock — looking harmless on the outside but with predatory eyes visible underneath. On the other side, a tree with beautiful leaves but rotten fruit falling from it. The crowd looks alarmed at the warning. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Watch out for false prophets. They come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ferocious wolves. By their fruit you will recognize them." Jesus warned that not everyone who claims to speak for God actually does. False teachers look harmless — even attractive — on the outside, but they devour those who follow them. How do you identify them? By their fruit. Not their charisma, not their popularity, not their miracles — but the long-term fruit of their lives and teaching. Does their teaching produce humility or pride? Generosity or greed? Love or control? Character is revealed over time, not in a single performance.

[illegible]

(Kab hasewti nebiyat tetinqeq. Bikhdan abagii yimetsukhum gin biwishitom chekanat arun tekula'yom. Bifri'om kitfillitwom ikhum. Yesus ni'Amlak yizareb zibil kulu bihaqi kem zeygebir ateneqe. Hasewti memhiran bidege zeyiGodu — sahbi'wun — yimeslu gin nizisi'ibwom yiwihitu. Bikemey tililiywom? Bifri'om. Bifiluy bahri'om zeyikone bihibibnetom zeyikone bite'amratom zeyikone — binay newih qize

*fire hiwtom'n timhirtom'n. Timhirtom tihitina wey ti'ibit yefri'do? Legasnet wey sisi'e?
Fiqri wey miqutststsar? Bahri bigize'yu zigilits bihanti fitsame ayikonen.)*

Scene 22

[PICTURE: Jesus speaking sternly about those who claim to know Him but don't. People approach a closed heavenly gate saying "Lord, Lord!" with scrolls listing their deeds. Jesus stands on the other side with a sorrowful but firm expression, turning them away. The contrast between religious performance and genuine relationship is stark. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the kingdom of heaven, but only the one who does the will of my Father who is in heaven. Many will say to me on that day, 'Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in your name and in your name drive out demons and in your name perform many miracles?' Then I will tell them plainly, 'I never knew you. Away from me, you evildoers!'" This is the most terrifying passage in the sermon. People can do impressive religious things — even miracles — while having no genuine relationship with Jesus. Religious activity without heart transformation is worthless. God is not impressed by performance; He desires authentic relationship and obedience.

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(Goyta Goyta zibileni kulu ab mengiste semayat zi'atu ayikonen nay ab semay zelo
Aboy fiqad zigebir tiray'yu. Buzuhat beta me'alti "Goyta Goyta bisimka
ayitenebnan'do bisimka aganninti ayisegognan'do bisimka buzuh te'amrat

ayigeberman'do?" kibluni'yom. Shi'u bigiltsii kinegrom'ye "Fetsime ayifeletkhukhumni kabay rihhaqu geberti abesa!" Izi ab sibket aziyu zefirih kifa'yu. Sebat zideniq haymanotawi negeraat — te'amrat'wun — mis Yesus haqenya rikib bizeyimhilaw kigibru yikhilu. Bizey nay libi miqiyar haymanotawi nitifet waga-albo'yu. Amlak bifitsame ayigremn; haqenya rikib'n mi'iziznet'n'yu zideli.)

Scene 23

[PICTURE: A dramatic split scene of two houses in a storm. On the left, a strong stone house built on solid rock foundation stands firm while rain, wind, and floods crash against it. The builder (wise man) watches calmly from inside. On the right, a house on sand collapses spectacularly as floods wash away its foundation. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Therefore everyone who hears these words of mine and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on the rock. The rain came down, the streams rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house; yet it did not fall, because it had its foundation on the rock." Jesus concluded His sermon with a parable everyone could understand. Two builders, two houses, one storm. The difference wasn't in what they heard — both heard the same teaching. The difference was in what they did with it. Obedience is the foundation. Hearing without doing is self-deception.

[illegible]

(Slezi nezen qalatey semi'u zigebrein kulu ab kewhi zihanitse geza zihanetse lebam seb'ay yimesil. Zinam werede zara abeye nifas nefese neta geza weqe'a gin ayiwedeqetn mikiniyatu ab kewhi'ya tehanitsa zineberet. Yesus nisibketu bikulu seb zirde'o misla demdeme. Kilte hanetsiti kilte abayti hade may-bred. Iti filliy ab zismi'iwo ayineberen — kilt'om hade timhirti semi'u. Filliy ab zigebrwo'yu zinebere. Mi'izaz'yu seret. Bizey miqbar misma'e ri'iskha mitilal'yu.)

Scene 24

[PICTURE: The foolish builder's house in ruins — broken timbers, scattered stones, and muddy sand washing away in floodwaters. The foolish man sits in the wreckage, devastated and regretful. In the background, the wise man's house on the rock still stands strong and lit from within. The storm clears above the rock house. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"But everyone who hears these words of mine and does not put them into practice is like a foolish man who built his house on sand. The rain came down, the streams rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house, and it fell with a great crash." The storms of life come to everyone — believer and unbeliever, obedient and disobedient. Suffering is not the difference. The difference is whether your life survives the storm. A life built on obedience to Jesus holds firm when everything shakes. A life built on mere religious knowledge, good intentions, or cultural Christianity collapses when truly tested. The question is not "Will storms come?" but "What is my life built on?"

"ገና ነደጅ ባላቴይ ሼሚ'ህ ጌይጎጅብረን ኪህል ልብ ከሁታ ገረጸ ጸሕነቴ ሳሕላ ሼ'ሃይ ሃይሜሲል። ጸሕነቴ ደረጃ ልብሃይ ክፍሪ ክፍሪ ክፍሪ ገረጸ ሃይሜታ ልብ'ላብ ደሙሲ ደሙሲ ደሙሲ። ሃይሃወት ሃይ-ብረድ ክህሊ ሃይሜቲ'ይ — ልሙኒ ጌሃ'ልሙኒ ሙ'ኒህ ጌሃሚ'ኒህ። ሲባሃ ፋሊኒ ሳይክኖኖ። ፋሊኒ ሃይሜቱክላ ነቴ ሃይ-ብረድ'ድ ቲቲሰኒክ'ሃ። ልብ ሙ'ኒሂ ጌሄሳኒቲሰቴ ሃይሜት ኪህል ክላኒወቴ ክሪ ቲሰኒክ። ልብ ሃይሃኑወገወገወ።"

(Gin nezen qalatey semi'u zeyigebrein kulu ab hutsa geza zihanetse asha seb'ay yimesil. Zinam werede zara abeye nifas nefese neta geza weqe'a bi'abi dimtsi dima wedeqet. Nay hiwet may-bred nikulu yimetsi'e — amani zeya'amani mi'izuz zeymi'izuz. Siqay filliy ayikonen. Filliy hiwetkha neti may-bred'do titsenih'ya. Ab mi'izaz Yesus zitehanitset hiwet kulu kinawets kelo tsinue titsenih. Ab haymanotawi

filiget tsibuq ilama wey bahlawi kristina tiray zitehanitset hiwet bihaqi kitiften kela tiwediq. Hito "may-bred'do yimetse'e?" zeyikone "hiwetey ab li'ili intay tehaniitsu?" zibil'yu.)

Scene 25

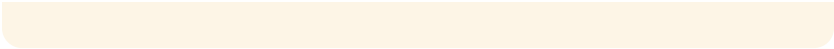
[PICTURE: The crowd sitting in stunned, reverent silence after Jesus finishes speaking. Their faces show amazement, conviction, and wonder. Some wipe tears, others look transformed. Jesus sits peacefully, the hillside bathed in late afternoon golden light. The Sea of Galilee glistens in the background. A sense of holy authority fills the scene. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"When Jesus had finished saying these things, the crowds were amazed at His teaching, because He taught as one who had authority, and not as their teachers of the law." The people recognized something unprecedented. The scribes quoted other rabbis; Jesus spoke on His own authority. He didn't say "Rabbi So-and-so teaches..." He said "But I tell you." This was either the speech of a madman or the speech of God Himself. The Sermon on the Mount leaves no room for calling Jesus merely a "good teacher." His claims are too radical, His authority too absolute. He demands total allegiance — heart, mind, soul, and strength — or nothing at all.

"ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገ ገገ ገገገገ
ገገገገገገ ገገ ገገገገገ ገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገ" ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገ
ገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገ
"ገገ ገገገ ገገገገ..." ገገገገገገ "ገገ ገገ ገገገገገገ" ገገገ ገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገ ገገ
ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገገ "ገገገ ገገገገገ" ገገገ
ገገገገገገ ገገ ገገገገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገ ገገገ
ገገገገገገገ — ገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ — ገገ ገገ ገገገ ገገገገገገ

(Yesus nezen negeraat mis wedee hizbi bitimhirtu tegereme mikiniyatu kem siltan zelewo'mber kem memhiran higi zeyikone yimhir nebere. Hizbi qidmi'u zeytere'aye neger alelye. Tsehafti nikhal'ot rebitat yitiqisu neberu; Yesus binay ba'ilu siltan tezarebe. "Rebi igele yimhir..." aybelen "Ane gin iblekhum" bele. Izi nay ibud wey nay Amlak ba'ilu nigir'yu zinebere. Sibket ab keren niYesus "tsibuq memhir" tiray

nimitswa'e bota ayigedifin. Awajatu aziyom sewrawyan siltanu fitsum'yu. Milu'e te'ammannet — libi a'imro nefsi hayli — wey wala hanti yihitit.)



Bible Verse / ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ

"In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

— Matthew 5:16

"ቅዱስ ሰው ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ ሰው ቅዱስ ሰው ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት
ሰው ቅዱስ ሰው ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት" — ቅዱስ 5:16

*("Kemu'u dima tsibuq gibirkhum ri'iyom ab semay nizelo Abokhum kekhibru
birhankhum ab qidmi sebat yebrih." — Matewos 5:16)*

(Goyta Yesus nay sibket ab keren qalatka fitsum yiqeli'una. Buzuh gize biwagagat alem kem ninebir ni'amin — miqibal nideli qut'a nihiz bitsibah nichiniq nay ba'ilna widqet resi'ina nikhal'ot nifrid. Yiqire bilena. Bahriyat tiray zeyikone libna qeyir. Bihaqi bimenfes dikhhatat — ni'akha kem zedliyena zifeltu giberena. Selam halewti tiray zeyikone selam geberti giberena. Nitsel'itina kinifetu nizihaseayuna kinihadig bizey taqiit tsibuu kingebir sewrawi tib'at habena. Mengistikha qidim kindeli kulu kal'e ni'akha kini'amin miharena. Hiwetina ab tsinue kewhi mi'izaz kinihanits hagizena ab nay tsibuu ilama ziniqesakwes hutsa zeyikone. Ta'imu zeyitefie chew zeyhiba'e birhan giberena. Beza sibket binay ba'ilna hayli kininbir ayinikhiln — neti zeyike'al ke'al nimenfes Qidusika bitesfa miqurats nedliyo. Bisimka nitsili Amen.)

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 50 of 60

Thank you for reading! We pray this story challenges you to build your life on the radical, countercultural values of Jesus' kingdom — to be salt and light in a world that desperately needs both, and to move from merely hearing God's word to actively obeying it.

በዚ ቅጽ ውስጥ የተጻፈው ስራ በጥንቃቄ ለመገምገም ይገባል፡፡
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